

Memories of Velldenar

Chapter 1

Memory is a liar.

Elara had known this for years, in the abstract way
one knows that fire is hot or that water runs downhill.
She had known it the way scholars know things:
from a careful distance.

Then her brother died, and she learned it the real way.

Three weeks after the funeral, she could no longer
remember the exact sound of his laugh.
She could remember that it had been warm.
That it had been sudden. That it had made a room
feel larger than it was.
But the sound itself â the actual shape of it in the air â
was already gone.

[Placeholder text â Chapter I content will be added here]